

Daily Market Summary

July 23, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: **-0.44 → Bearish**

Trend (5-day EMA): **-0.16 → Slightly Bearish** — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	-0.57
News headlines	20%	-0.00
Reddit (disabled)	0%	-0.02
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	-0.37

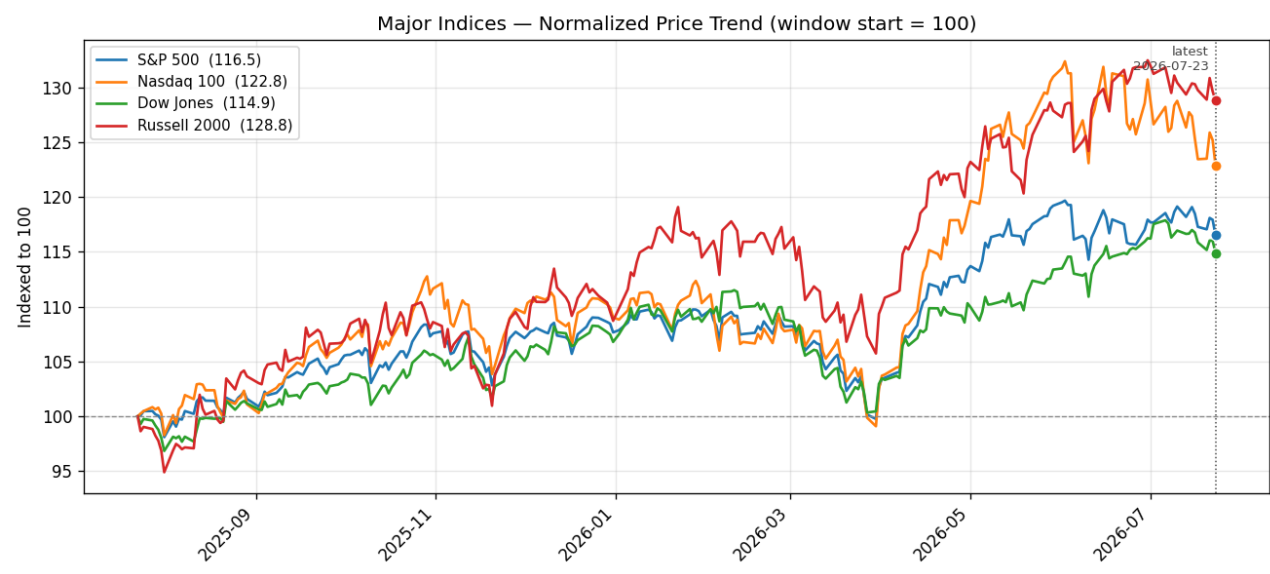
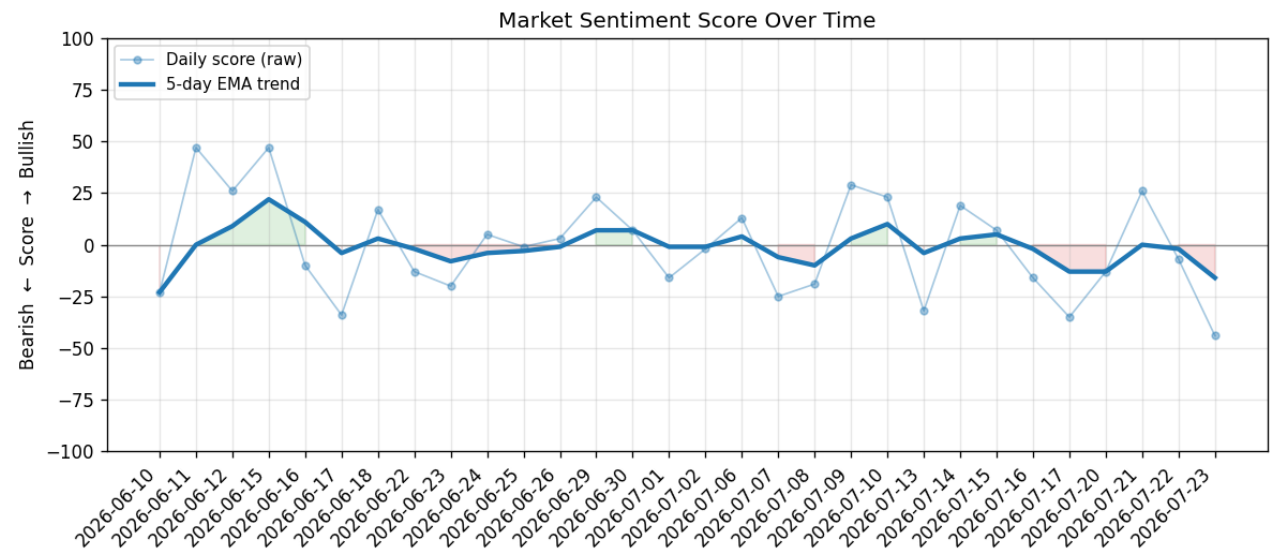
Equities fell with Nasdaq -1.9%, S&P 500 -1.2%, VIX +12.4%. Sector breadth: 4/11 sectors up. 10Y yield +1.0%. News headlines read neutral. Fed-policy expectations tightened (13-Week T-Bill Yield +5.5bp). Today's overall market tone: Bearish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.89) — JPMorgan report finds dramatic jump in AI-themed ETFs — despite rough quarter

Most bearish (-0.95) — ServiceNow's stock falls as a new AI threat overshadows earnings beat

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
Pharma / Healthcare	+1.42%	+2.63% vs S&P	81%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.64)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	+0.64%	+2.51% vs Nasdaq	50%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.35)
Networking / Interconnect	+0.33%	+2.20% vs Nasdaq	36%	Slightly Bullish	Slightly Bullish (+0.18)
Banking	-0.92%	+0.29% vs S&P	75%	Slightly Bearish	Bearish (-0.35)
Semiconductors / Compute	-1.22%	+0.65% vs Nasdaq	35%	Slightly Bullish	Bearish (-0.51)
Consumer	-1.02%	+0.19% vs S&P	12%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.55)
SaaS	-2.48%	-0.61% vs Nasdaq	28%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.84)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	-3.36%	-1.49% vs Nasdaq	7%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.89)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
Banking	1.94	0.0%	-0.92%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	1.50	5.3%	+0.64%	Bullish — advance, but heavily hedged — protection still bid
Consumer	0.63	1.9%	-1.02%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Networking / Interconnect	0.61	4.3%	+0.33%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Semiconductors / Compute	0.57	2.5%	-1.22%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Pharma / Healthcare	0.41	1.7%	+1.43%	Bullish — complacent advance — few hedges or shorts in place

SaaS	0.39	5.5%	-2.48%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.32	1.6%	-3.36%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
All tracked	0.54	2.4%	-0.91%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
NovoCure Limited (NVCR)	19.99	+28.39%
Cleveland-Cliffs Inc. (CLF)	10.96	+15.98%
Medpace Holdings, Inc. (MEDP)	605.82	+14.71%
EquipmentShare.com Inc (EQPT)	19.40	+11.88%
Imax Corporation (IMAX)	43.96	+11.86%

Top News

The August stock-market slump is a myth — so why does Wall Street keep repeating it? — MarketWatch (Top)

More than 200 years of data show stocks typically gain in August, while market volatility sits well below average.

Stocks making the biggest moves after hours: Intel, AMD, Boston Beer, Deckers & more — CNBC (Finance)

These are the stocks posting the largest moves after the bell.

Market Technology Acquisition Corp prices \$200M IPO on Nasdaq — Investing.com

S&P 500 flashes sell signals — options traders are bracing for wild swings in Apple, Meta and Microsoft — MarketWatch (Top)

Nervous investors set the stage for massive post-earnings moves in Wall Street's biggest stocks.

Odds of Federal Reserve rate hike surge as oil prices rip higher — CNBC (Finance)

Investors are increasingly readying for the Federal Reserve to hike interest rates in September.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,408.30	-90.66	-1.21%
Nasdaq 100	28,454.81	-543.29	-1.87%
Dow Jones	51,711.65	-506.93	-0.97%
Russell 2000	2,940.16	-19.78	-0.67%
VIX	18.70	+2.06	+12.38%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	208.76	-3.30	-1.56%
Microsoft	381.58	-8.76	-2.24%
AMD	539.69	-12.64	-2.29%
Meta	606.10	-21.07	-3.36%
Alphabet	318.34	-23.57	-6.89%
Broadcom	392.47	-4.34	-1.09%
Micron	990.21	+30.73	+3.20%
Intel	100.23	-2.39	-2.33%
SanDisk	1,610.33	+11.06	+0.69%
Coherent	313.22	+1.03	+0.33%
Amazon	233.66	-11.19	-4.57%
Apple	321.66	-4.23	-1.30%
Arm	283.04	-0.36	-0.13%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,052.40	+2.20	+0.05%
Crude Oil	92.27	+0.08	+0.09%
Bitcoin	65,122.26	-892.12	-1.35%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.14	-0.00	-0.25%
USD/JPY	163.84	+0.75	+0.46%
GBP/USD	1.33	-0.01	-0.46%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.70	+0.05	+0.99%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.80	+0.06	+1.47%

Analyst Summary

Market Overview

U.S. equities sold off broadly on Thursday, with technology and mega-cap growth stocks bearing the brunt of the decline. The S&P 500 dropped 1.21%, while the Nasdaq 100 tumbled 1.87%, marking a sharp reversal in risk appetite. The Dow Jones fell 0.97%, and the Russell 2000 declined 0.67%. The VIX surged 12.38% to 18.70, reflecting heightened uncertainty as options traders positioned for elevated volatility in major tech names including Apple, Meta, and Microsoft.

Tech Weakness and Divergence

The session's most pronounced theme was a severe selloff in hyperscalers and large-cap tech. Alphabet plunged 6.89%, weighed down by reports of a \$1 billion EU fine. Amazon tumbled 4.57%, while Meta fell 3.36% and Microsoft declined 2.24%. The Hyperscalers & Neoclouds sector dropped 3.36%, with positioning data showing a remarkably low put/call ratio of 0.32—suggesting the decline caught complacent investors off guard with little hedging in place.

In stark contrast, the Memory sector rallied 0.64%, led by **Micron's** impressive 3.20% gain. **Intel** defied sector weakness in after-hours trading following a blowout forecast, with social media buzzing about "unprecedented demand" and the fastest sales growth in nearly 15 years. This bifurcation within semiconductors—with compute and AI chips under pressure while memory surges—signals a potential rotation within the tech stack.

Defensive Rotation and Top Gainers

Pharma/Healthcare emerged as the day's defensive winner, rising 1.42% with 81% breadth. Among individual standout performers, **NovoCure** (NVCR) skyrocketed 28.39%, while **Cleveland-Cliffs** (CLF) jumped 15.98% and **Medpace Holdings** (MEDP) gained 14.71%, suggesting pockets of idiosyncratic strength amid broad risk-off behavior.

Rates, Policy, and Cross-Asset Signals

Treasury yields climbed, with the 10-year rising 5 basis points to 4.70% and the 13-week T-bill up 6 basis points to 3.80%. CNBC reported surging odds of a Federal Reserve rate *hike* as oil prices continue to climb—a hawkish shift that likely contributed to tech's underperformance. The dollar strengthened against the euro and pound, while USD/JPY rose to 163.84, consistent with a higher-rates backdrop.

Gold and crude oil were essentially flat, while Bitcoin fell 1.35%, tracking risk-off sentiment. Overall positioning data reveals complacency across most sectors, with declining stocks showing minimal hedging demand—suggesting Thursday's move may have further to run.